

ECON 100B: Macroeconomics

Midterm scores and perspectives

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Good job!

I'm serious!

And here's why...

Recent midterm exam scores in fall and spring courses

	ECON 2	ECON 100B	ECON 140	ECON 151	ECON 157
Spring 2026		40.0 (66.6%)			42.8 (71.2%)
Fall 2025	45.0 (75.0%)			44.7 (74.4%)	
Spring 2025			40.6 (67.7%)		46.9 (78.1%)
Fall 2024			43.6 (72.7%)		
Spring 2024				40.3 (67.2%)	45.1 (75.1%)
Fall 2023			46.0 (76.7%)		

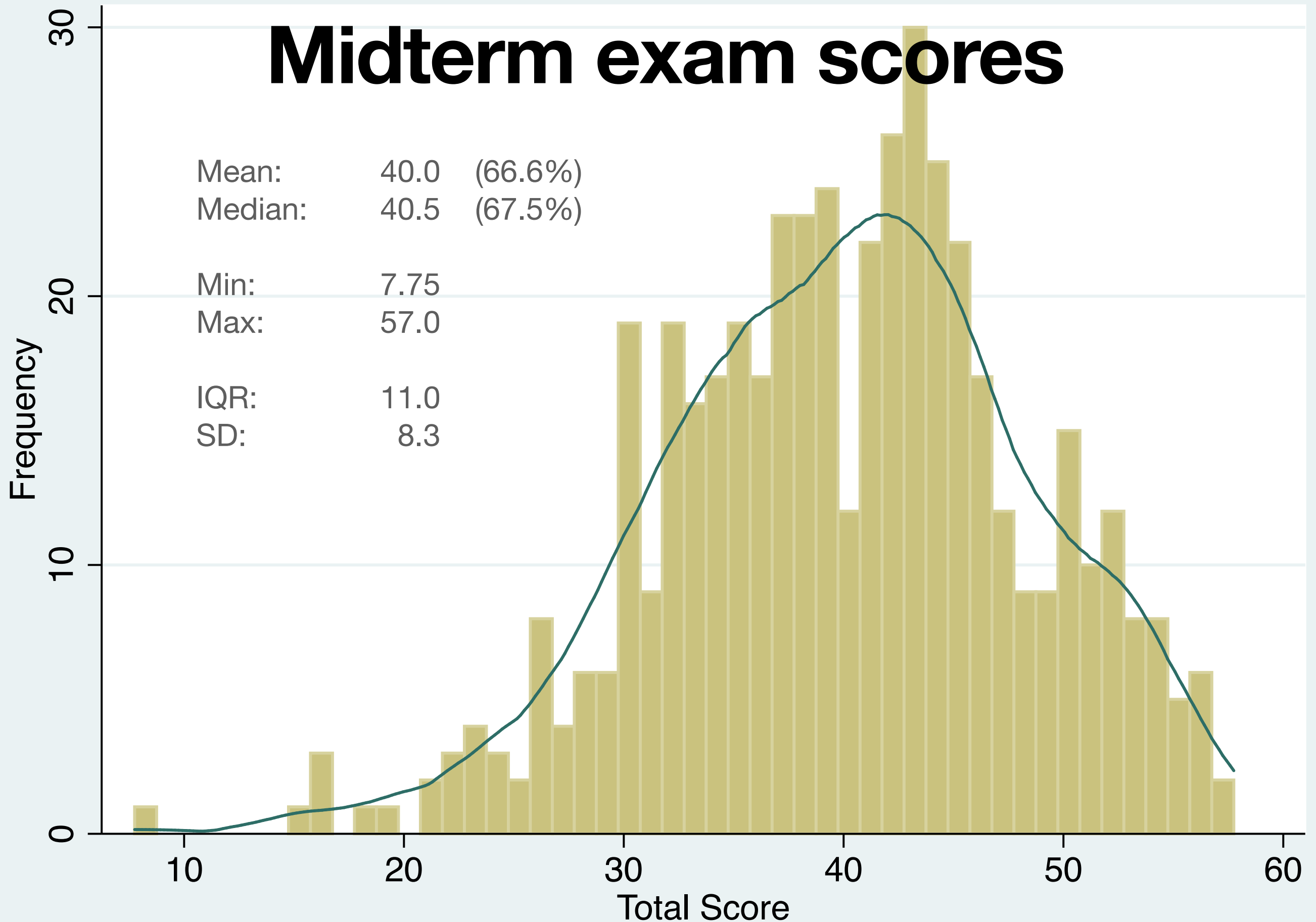
All exams were 60 minutes long and contained 60 possible points. Enrollments ranged between 225 and 510

Midterm exam scores

Mean: 40.0 (66.6%)
Median: 40.5 (67.5%)

Min: 7.75
Max: 57.0

IQR: 11.0
SD: 8.3



The view inside **bCourses Grades** for the average student


Account
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Student Rights and Options

- Home
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- Assignments
- Discussions
- Grades**
- People
- Pages
- Files
- Syllabus
- Quizzes
- Collaborations
- Chat
- Media Gallery
- Poll Everywhere
- Ed Discussion
- Academic Integrity

Plagiarism Quiz	100%	13.00 / 13.00
Class Participation	N/A	0.00 / 0.00
Problem Sets	100%	42.00 / 42.00
Out-sick Exams (Midterm and Final)	N/A	0.00 / 0.00
In-person Midterm Exam	66.67%	40.00 / 60.00
Midterm Essay (Take-home)	N/A	0.00 / 0.00
In-person Final Exam	N/A	0.00 / 0.00
Final Essay (Take- home)	N/A	0.00 / 0.00
Academic Integrity Course Participation Assignment	N/A	0.00 / 0.00
Total	83.66%	

bCourses shows you an estimate of the eventual score

	weight	score	weight x score
Plagiarism+	1%	100.00%	1.00%
Participation			
Problem sets	25%	100.00%	25.00%
Midterm exam	25%	66.67%	16.67%
Midterm essay			
Final exam			
Final essay			
sum	51%		42.67%
ratio = grade estimate		$42.67\% \div 51\% =$	83.66%

When the Midterm essay is scored, it will increase scores and forecasts

	weight	score	weight x score
Plagiarism+	1%	100.00%	1.00%
Participation			
Problem sets	25%	100.00%	25.00%
Midterm exam	25%	66.67%	16.67%
Midterm essay	10%	100.0%	10.0%
Final exam			
Final essay			
sum	61%		52.67%
ratio = grade estimate		$52.67\% \div 61\% =$	86.34%

If the future looks like the present, the present is a good indicator

	weight	score	weight x score
Plagiarism+	1%	100.00%	1.00%
Participation	4%	100.00%	4.00%
Problem sets	25%	100.00%	25.00%
Midterm exam	25%	66.67%	16.67%
Midterm essay	10%	100.00%	10.00%
Final exam	25%	66.67%	16.67%
Final essay	10%	100.00%	10.00%
sum	100%		83.34%
ratio = grade estimate		83.34% ÷ 100% =	83.34%

The reason the percentage falls a little is because at midterm, a little more than half the completed credit was drawn from highly scored activities. By the end, exactly half is.

Regrade requests

- We are happy to find and correct any mistakes. Mistakes happen
- But GSIs are careful and typically don't make mistakes. Scores usually are not changed
- Regrade requests will trigger a new look at the whole exam
 - Maybe handwriting was tough to read throughout. Consider approaching DSP for future exams
 - Awarding partial credit is the right thing and a hard thing to do
- Regrades must be done through Gradescope before midnight on Wednesday 4/1. Requests that arrive late won't be accepted, no foolin'

2023 Economics Nobelist Claudia Goldin (2015) “Gender and the Undergraduate Economics Major”

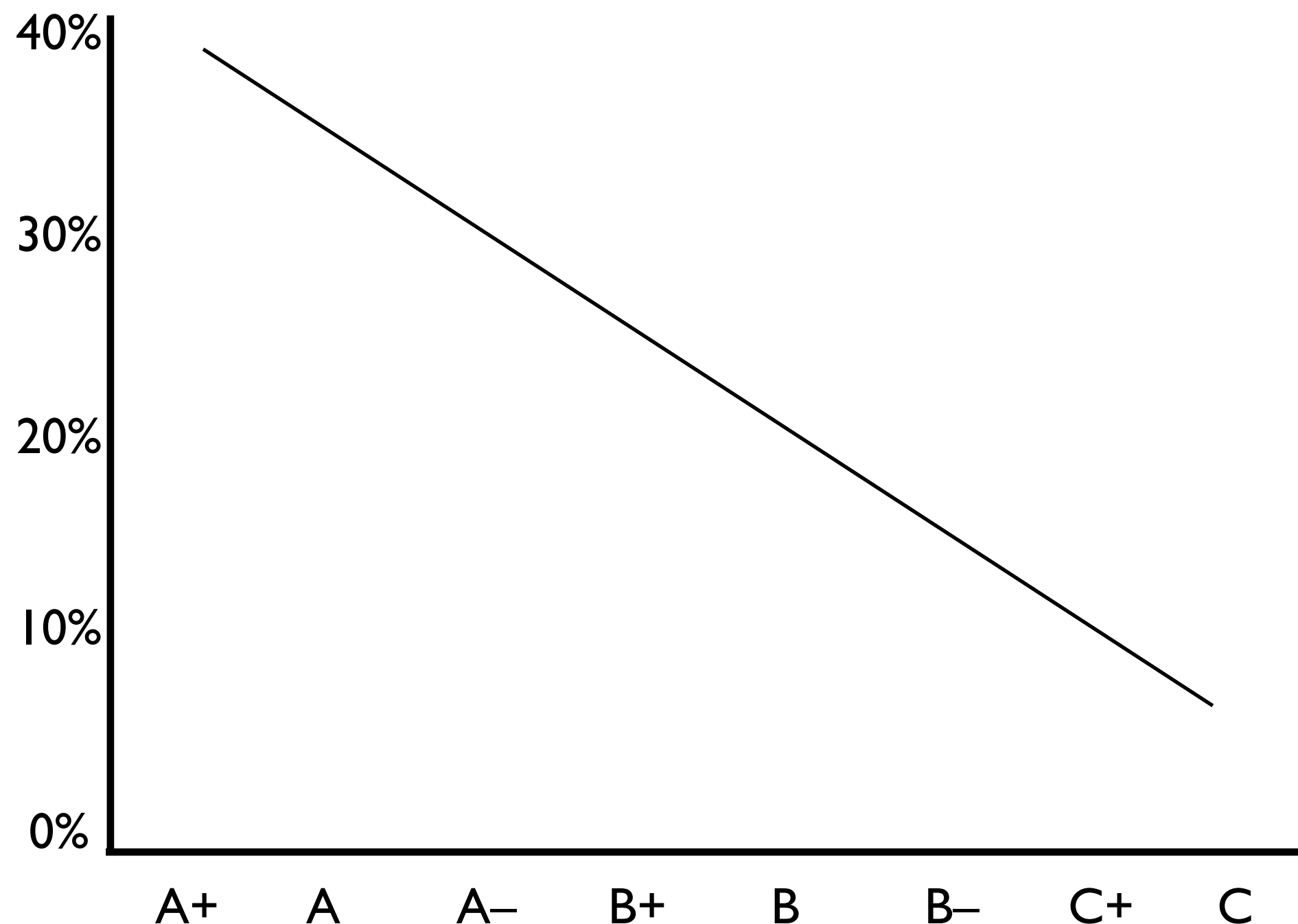
- Well over half of U.S. college students are female
- But there are big gender imbalances across majors, big differences in grades across majors, lower in science and econ
- Nationwide, there are three male economics majors for every female major, and the gap has been widening
- Why do we care? Economics majors earn more than others, and economics is broadly useful in careers beyond finance
- Why do we see these patterns? ...

Why?

- Differences in preferences or aspirations?
 - Maybe. Goldin says that men are more likely to enter college with the goal of majoring in economics
- Differences in math ability?
 - Not at all, says Goldin. If anything, female econ major candidates have higher math SATs
- Differences in responses to grades?

What kind of relationship should we see between grades in Econ 1 and probability of majoring in econ?

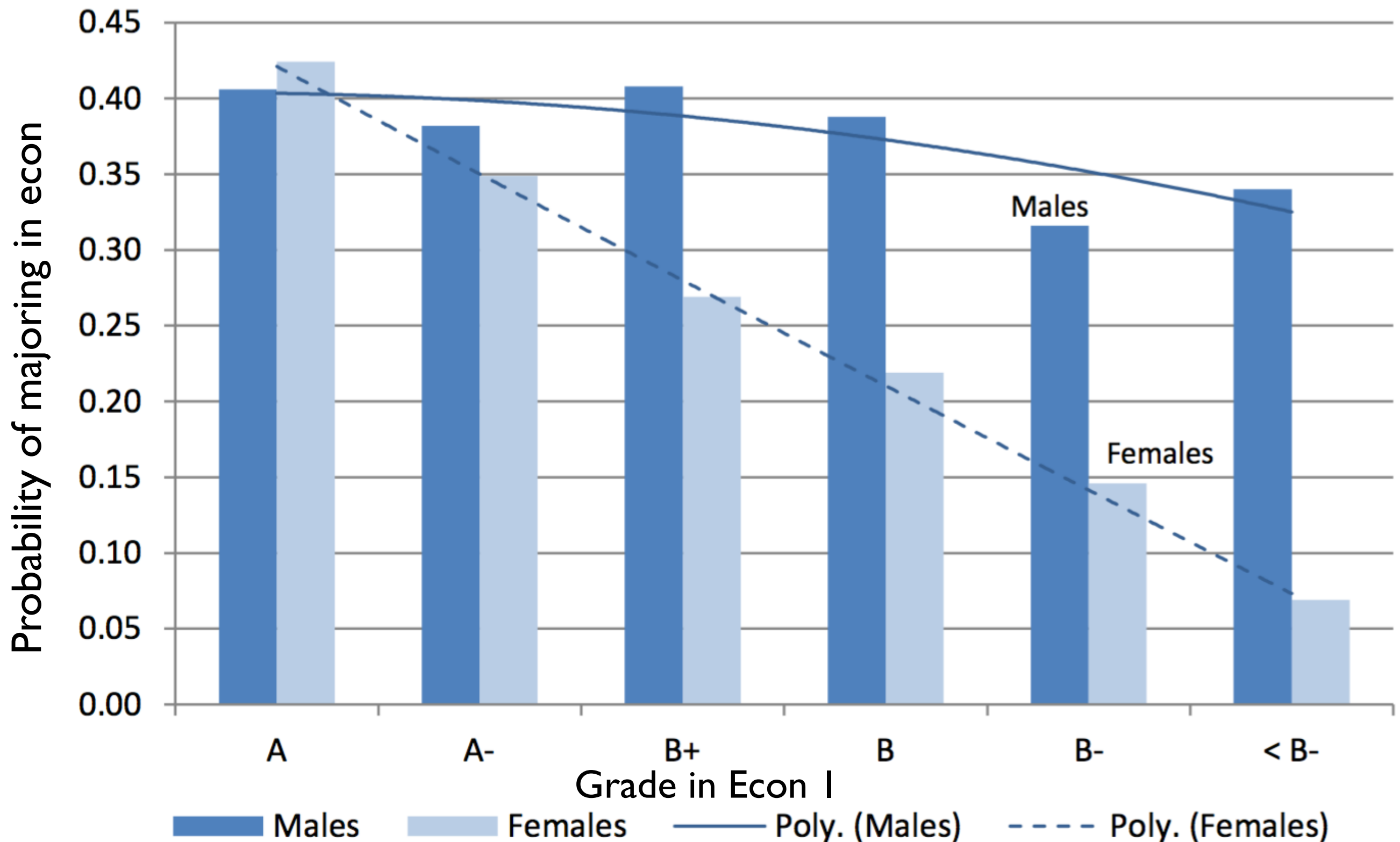
Probability of
majoring in econ



- For all students, you would expect to see a downward-sloping relationship
- The worse you do, the less likely you'd pick to major in economics

Grade in Econ 1

What do we see if we separate males and females?



Source: [Claudia Goldin/Harvard University](#) - This chart shows the percentage of male and female students who received a given grade in introductory economics course who then later majored in economics. Data refer to an anonymous research institution, from a study by Harvard Professor Claudia Goldin.

Hypotheses, reported by [Catherine Rampel \(WP 2014\)](#)

- Goldin: “Maybe women just don’t want to get things wrong.... They don’t want to walk around being a B-minus student in something. They want to find something they can be an A student in. They want something where the professor will ... say ‘You’re doing so well!’ Guys don’t seem to give two damns.”
- Rampel: “Male students could be more overconfident — effectively, college bros shrug off gentleman’s C’s (or, more often today, gentleman’s B’s) as unrepresentative of their true brilliance.”
- Goldin: Or maybe men have their “eyes on the prize”
- Rampel: “Men might be more likely to see themselves as future breadwinners and persevere in studies that are likely to maximize their earnings — come hell or high water or B-minuses.”

A visit from ECON 140 in S25

- 478 students with definitive Gemini guesses about the sex of the first name
 - 53.8% male
 - 46.2% female
- Midterm scores in the class were about the same
- **Total scores** in the class were:
 - 86.2% among males
 - 87.3% among females
 - (The 1.1 ppt difference was statistically insignificant)

[ECON reports](#) that its majors are 45% women

Students earning honors in economics

- I've supervised 17 honors theses since 2021
- 71% have been completed by female students
- 29% by male students

Great role models all around us

📌 Pinned



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Inspiring words from Fed Governor Adriana Kugler from Tuesday's ECON commencement at the Greek.

In person, "impatient" and "stubborn" struck me as perfect for this moment in history. On paper, they're less pronounced, but in an address they absolutely slapped

<https://www.federalreserve.gov/newsevents/speech/kugler20250520a.htm>



Commencement remarks by Governor Kugler at the Economics Commencement Ceremony, University of California, Berkeley

Thank you, Stefano, and before I say anything else, congratulations to the Class of 2025! 1 My family is here today, so let me acknowledge my ...

www.federalreserve.gov

Adriana Kugler
earned her Ph.D.
here at Berkeley
in 1997

[YouTube video of entire 2025 Commencement](#)

It was my honor to read half of the names!